



2025-2026

PARENT'S GUIDE TO STUDENT NUTRITION

Check out what's new for BREAKFAST AND LUNCH!

OrganicLife, our food service provider, is proud to be in partnership with Community Unit School District 300. OrganicLife wants to make your students' breakfast and lunch a positive and nutritious experience they look forward to. This brochure will guide you through the food service policies and procedures at District 300.

Meal Prices for the 2024-2025 School Year:

Student Paid Breakfast: \$ 1.80	Student Paid Lunch: \$3.30
Student Reduced Price Breakfast: \$ 0.30	Student Reduced Price Lunch: \$0.40
A la Carte Milk: \$.70 per carton	

Payment for Meals

PushCoin (preferred funding option):

Take advantage of District 300's online payment system [PushCoin](#). We have moved Meal Payments to the same system that has been used for Student Fees. Utilizing one system for all student payments will make providing funds for your child's breakfast and lunch an easy step. Account details such as account balance and purchase history are available. Email notifications can also be enabled for your student's meal account.

Cash or Check:

You can deposit money on your child's account by sending a check (made payable to Community Unit District 300) to school. We will deposit the funds to your child's account. Cash payments up to \$20 will be accepted at the point of service and change from the transaction will be applied to the student's account. Change will not be given to the student.

Check payments should be placed in a sealed envelope with your student's name and grade listed on the outside of the envelope. Please ensure that a contact number is included on the front of all checks submitted as payment.

If there is a meal charge on your account that you feel is in error and would like to dispute, you must contact us within 21 days of the charge. Parents are responsible for monitoring their child's meal account and the balance of the account.



A la Carte Pricing

A complete a la carte price list is available in each cafeteria. A wide variety of a la carte items are at the secondary schools. A la carte items cannot be charged to a student account. All items must be paid in full at the time of service with either a cash payment or through the student's account.

Free and Reduced-Priced Meals

Applications for free or reduced-price meals can be found on the [District website](#). Applications need to be submitted each new school year. An online application is available and can be accessed directly through this [link](#). If your circumstances change, you may apply at any time during the school year for consideration. Contact the district business office at FandRapps@d300.org or 847-551-8300 for additional details.

Charging of Meals

Per the Hunger-Free Students Bill of Rights, students will be allowed to choose a full breakfast and/or lunch (including choice of entrée, fruit, vegetable, grain, and milk) regardless of whether the student has the ability to pay or has a negative student balance on their meal account. Meals are considered full reimbursable meals and will continue to be debited from the student's meal account. Unpaid student accounts, including fee and meal accounts, are subject to collections. Please note that ala carte items including single cartons of milk, may not be charged to a student's account under any circumstances.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is "Offer Versus Serve?"

Under the "Offer Versus Serve" provision, Public Law 97-35 "Offer Versus Serve" allows a student to make food choices from a selection of food items on the cafeteria serving line. Research studies have shown that allowing students to make their own choices has reduced waste, increased participation, and increased the consumption of fruits, vegetables, and grains. Students are required to take necessary components for a breakfast or a lunch, otherwise, items on the tray will be charged as a la carte.



Breakfast meal components: Three items from the menu for the day must be selected, with a fruit being a required item.

Lunch meal components: Three out of five of the items on the menu for the day must be selected, with a fruit or vegetable being a required item. Up to five items may be chosen from the daily offerings. Sample: entrée, fruit, vegetable, grain, and/or milk.

What Makes a School Breakfast



grain



fruit (or vegetable)



milk

Offer Vs. Serve
Choose **at least 3 items** from the four offered, **One must be** a 1/2 cup of **fruit** (or **vegetable**).



The fourth item offered may be another grain, another fruit or veggie, or a meat or meat alternate.

The 5 Components of a School Lunch



meat/meat alternate



grain



milk

Offer Vs. Serve
Choose **1/2 cup fruit**, or **1/2 cup vegetable**, or 1/2 cup **combination**, and **at least 2 other components**. **Choose all 5 for the best nutrition!**



fruit



vegetable

How does the Office of Food Services determine the portion size served in each meal?

When menu planning takes place, the USDA requires that all planned meals meet the nutritional requirements for the highest grade level served in a building. For example, a school servicing grades K-5 will have meals served to meet the nutritional requirements of a fifth grader. Meals are based upon the appropriate calories, nutrient requirements, vitamins, minerals, sugar, and fat restrictions. Because District 300 participates in the National School Breakfast and National School Lunch Programs, these regulations must be closely adhered to by the Office of Food Services.

What if my child has a special dietary need?

You must contact the school nurse to receive the necessary form that must be completed by a physician providing the medical need for care. The school nurse will then provide a copy of the doctor's statement to the Office of Food Services. Arrangements will be made to reasonably accommodate the student's special dietary needs.



Where can I find nutritional information?

On the Food Service webpage, nutrition information can be found under [NutriSlice](#). Use this new website to learn about menus, nutritional information for the foods served, special promotions and other topics.

About OrganicLife

OrganicLife is locally based in Chicago, IL. At OrganicLife, we believe in nourishing young bodies and minds with freshly prepared, nutritious meals each and every day. We are committed to bettering the lives of the students we serve, and we pride ourselves on being an innovative, attentive, involved foodservice partner.

Employment Opportunities

Interested in a work schedule that fits with your child's school schedule? We have many opportunities to fit your needs including part-time and full-time positions for both lunchroom monitors or food service team members. Email [Susan Sindles](#) with your questions.



For menu options, nutritional information and wellness education tips, check out our [NutriSlice](#) website.

Contact Information

For information about the food service program, contact the Student Nutrition office directly. Student Nutrition Office contact number: (847) 551-8300 or at Food.Service@d300.org

Thank you for your support and cooperation. We look forward to another successful school year. Please do not hesitate to contact us with any questions.